

Chapter 118-1

It was already past eleven o'clock, and the rhythm of the entire city had slowed down, with traffic on the roads decreasing.

The cold wind of late autumn had already stripped the leaves from the branches of trees on both sides of the road, leaving them all bare.

In a coffee shop diagonally across from Ruijing Hotel, there were very few customers, with only the innermost table occupied.

Black long hair, wearing a blue hat, a puff-sleeve fitted top, high-waisted wide-leg pants that made her waist look slender.

She had ordered a cappuccino and was sitting in the corner.

But the heat from the coffee had already dissipated, and the latte art on the surface remained untouched. She kept her head down, constantly poking at her phone.

The contact name on the screen was an emoji: sheep.

[Still not coming?]

[If you don't come, I'm leaving.]

[The coffee shop is about to close.]

The other person only replied with one sentence: [Almost there.]

The person playing with her phone replied impatiently: [So slow.]

Just as this message was sent, the coffee shop door was pushed open.

A woman in a grass-green coat brushed back her wind-tousled curly hair. When the staff came forward and said to her: "Miss, we're about to close," the woman raised her chin: "I'm looking for someone."

As for whom she was looking for, it went without saying.

There was only this one customer in the entire shop. The staff member also felt exhausted. Originally, they were supposed to close at eleven, but this young lady had come in at ten-thirty, ordered a cup of coffee, and just sat there. It was already past their closing time. They had already given a subtle reminder once, but she had only said: "Wait a bit longer."

She hadn't even drunk the coffee.

The shop couldn't forcibly drive out customers at closing time. Several staff members who had been standing all day and were exhausted to death kept staring at that customer, just hoping she would be considerate.

But they didn't expect that customer was waiting for a friend.

If they chatted in the shop for a while longer..

Just thinking about it made the staff member's scalp tingle.

Zhang Yangning, who had barely managed to extract herself from a drinking party after organizing a welcome ceremony for a newly hired employee, arrived late, still reeking of alcohol.

Zhang Yangning walked to the table in the corner and sat down. After taking a sip of the coffee that had already cooled on the table, she immediately frowned: "What is this taste?"

"It's been sitting for an hour," the person across from her said, her voice cold, carrying several notes of gloom.

Zhang Yangning placed her bag on the chair beside her and raised her hand to ask the staff for a glass of water.

The staff member hesitated, but then Zhang Yangning's phoenix eyes slanted upward: "No coffee, and not even a glass of water?"

"We have it." To avoid trouble, the staff member immediately went to pour her a glass of water.

Zhang Yangning took a sip—it was a bit hot. She frowned, about to lose her temper, but was stopped by the person across from her: "That's enough."

"Ranran." After drinking the water, her throat wasn't as parched as before, and her speech became softer. She smiled at the person across from her: "You're angry."

Only then did the woman raise her head. Her eyes were impossibly red, looking rather frightening.

It was Liang Xinran.

Zhang Yangning was also startled: "My god, sweetie, what happened to you? Why are your eyes like a little rabbit's?"

"Cried too much," Liang Xinran said coldly.

Zhang Yangning: "....."

"What happened?" Zhang Yangning asked.

Liang Xinran glanced at the water in her hand: "Done drinking? Let's talk outside."

Zhang Yangning hesitated, not really wanting to go outside and be blown by the cold wind. But Liang Xinran had already gotten up and was heading out.

A few seconds later, Zhang Yangning gulped down the water, grabbed her bag from the chair, and followed.

Her bag was a name brand, five figures¹.

The clothes on her body were also quite pricey.

After they left, the coffee shop staff were still gossiping—that person's demeanor was like a nouveau riche.

Zhang Yangning, who had already left, didn't know this. As soon as she went out, she was frozen through. She chased after Liang Xinran asking: "Where are we going?"

Liang Xinran said: "Don't talk for now."

Zhang Yangning: "....."

She looked around—nothing unusual.

Besides, out here on the main street, so far from the Liang family and Dongheng, who could see the two of them?

Really paranoid.

However, Zhang Yangning only thought this in her heart and obediently did as Liang Xinran said.

Footnote:

¹ Five figures (五位数): Refers to the price being in the tens of thousands (10,000-99,999 RMB, approximately \$1,400-\$14,000 USD), indicating an expensive designer bag.